

Sweet Child O' Mine -- Guns N' Roses

Appetite for Destruction, 1987. ~125 BPM.

GP-5 only, P/J bass, no pedalboard.

Duff McKagan plays with a pick and comes from punk. The tone is bright, mid-forward, and a little gritty, with pick attack that cuts through two Les Pauls.

The "Where do we go now?" outro gets heavier and darker, and the band digs in hard.

AMP: Classic Bass (Ampeg SVT) + CAB: Hartke410 IR (User IR 6)

This is a real bass rig, not a guitar amp. The grit comes from the SVT being pushed plus the aluminum-cone Hartke.

Hartke410's bright, aggressive aluminum cones are a direct fit for picked-bass clank and attack.

- Gain: 40. Edge of breakup. Hard pick attack growls, lighter playing stays clean.
- Bass: 55.
- Middle: 60, MidFreq: 800Hz. This is where a picked bass cuts.
- Treble: 58. Pick definition.
- VOL: 65. CAB VOL: 58.

Module chain

NR -- Gate, always on.

THRE: 20. The edge-of-breakup amp plus the bright cab make some hiss, so this is slightly firmer than a clean patch.

PRE -- COMP4 (Keeley C4), always on.

Sustain: 50, Attack: 40, Clip: 30, VOL: 60.

Evens out the picked eighth notes. Attack at 40 keeps the pick transient.

DST -- Bass OD, on CTL.

Gain: 38, Blend: 42, VOL: 62, Bass: 50, Treble: 55.

Blend at 42 keeps the clean low end underneath, so the drive adds snarl without thinning out the bottom.

AMP -- Classic Bass, always on. Gain 40, Bass 55, Middle 60, MidFreq 800Hz, Treble 58, VOL 65.

CAB -- User IR 6 (Hartke410), always on. VOL 58.

EQ -- Bass EQ 1, always on.

33Hz: 0, 150Hz: +1, 600Hz: +2, 2kHz: +3, 8kHz: +1, VOL: 54.

Mids and upper mids pushed, which is where Duff's tone lives. The sub is left flat so it doesn't mud up against the kick.

MOD -- off.

DLY -- off.

RVB -- off. Appetite's rhythm section is dry and in your face.

CTL footswitch

One module on CTL: DST (Bass OD).

- **CTL off:** intro, verses, and choruses. Bright, picked, lightly gritty. This is the resting state.
- **CTL on:** the "Where do we go now?" outro breakdown and Slash's solo. Extra snarl and weight for the heaviest part of the song.

Engage when the song shifts into the outro. Back off if you loop back to a verse.